

DIRECTIONS *for questions 1 to 4:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Edward Said's evaluation and critique of the set of beliefs known as Orientalism forms an important background for postcolonial studies.

The Orient signifies a system of representations framed by political forces that brought the Orient into Western learning, consciousness and empire. The Orient exists for the West and is constructed by and in relation to the West. It is a mirror image of what is inferior and alien ('Other') to the West.

The first 'Orientalists' were 19th century scholars who translated the writings of 'the Orient' into English, based on the assumption that a truly effective colonial conquest required knowledge of the conquered peoples. ... The most significant construction of Orientalist scholars is that of the Orient itself. What is considered the Orient is a vast region, one that spreads across a myriad of cultures and countries.

Said argues that Orientalism can be found in current Western depictions of 'Arab' cultures: as "irrational", "menacing", "untrustworthy", "anti-Western", "dishonest"... These notions are trusted as foundations for both ideologies and policies developed by the Occident. Said writes: 'One would find this kind of procedure less objectionable as political propaganda - which is what it is, of course - were it not accompanied by sermons on the objectivity, the fairness, the impartiality of a real historian, the implication always being that Muslims and Arabs cannot be objective, but that Orientalists ... writing about Muslims are, by definition, by training, by the mere fact of their Westernness.'

Said calls into question the underlying assumptions that form the foundation of Orientalist thinking. A rejection of Orientalism entails a rejection of biological generalizations, cultural constructions, and racial and religious prejudices. It is a rejection of greed as a primary motivating factor in intellectual pursuit. It is an erasure of the line between 'the West' and "the Other". Said argues for the use of 'narrative' rather than 'vision' in interpreting the geographical landscape known as the Orient, meaning that a historian and a scholar would turn not to a panoramic view of half of the globe but to a focused and complex type of history that allows space for the dynamic variety of human experience. Rejection of Orientalist thinking does not entail a denial of the differences between 'the West' and 'the Orient', but rather an evaluation of such differences in a critical and objective fashion. 'The Orient' cannot be studied in a non-Orientalist manner; rather, the scholar is obliged to study more focussed and smaller culturally consistent regions. **The person who has until now been known as 'the Oriental' must be given a voice. Scholarship from afar and second-hand representation must take a back seat to narrative and self-representation on the part of the 'Oriental'.**

Q1. Which of the following can be understood from the boldfaced portions of the passage?

- ☐ a) Postcolonial studies advocate the renewal of Eastern cultures and a rejection of Western influence over them.
- ☐ b) Internalizing colonial assumptions about the inferiority of the conquered peoples and constructing the Orient through the lens of Europeans form the substratum of postcolonial studies.
- ☐ c) Postcolonial studies highlight the economic exploitation of native people and analyze the western ways of depicting the Eastern world.
- ☐ d) Postcolonial studies should question western conceptions of the Orient and assimilate the Orientalist sentiment.

Q2. Which of the following statements about 'Orientalism' is false as per the passage?

- ☐ a) The discourse of Orientalism is laced with notions of political power, formulated to facilitate a colonizing mission on the part of the West.
- ☒ b) **According to Said, a rejection of Orientalism entails a denial of the differences between 'the West' and 'the Orient'.** ✓ Your answer is correct.
- ☐ c) Though the Orient is a vast region, a scholar of Orientalism should study more focussed and smaller culturally homogeneous regions.
- ☐ d) The identity of the Orient should be defined by the scholar who gives it a voice and life.

Q3. The author claims that, “The Orient exists for the West and is constructed by and in relation to the West.” Which one of the following statements best captures what the author implies from this statement, in the context of the passage?

- ☐ a) Since the notion of the Orient is created by the Orientalist, it exists solely for him or her.
- ☐ b) **The Orient is a servile follower of the ideologies and plans of the West.**
- ☐ c) The notion of the Orient as created by the West serves to indicate their perceived exclusivity.
- ☐ d) The Orient awaits the dominance of the West; it is a defenseless and unintelligent entity that depends on the Western counterpart to represent itself.

Q4. Based on the passage, Said would agree with all of the following arguments about Orientalism EXCEPT:

- ☐ a) The landscape of the Orient should be interpreted not as a panoramic view of half of the globe but rather as a complex type of history that takes into account the dynamic variety of human experience.
- ☐ b) **The foundation of Orientalist thinking as created by the West is based on underlying assumptions about biological generalizations, cultural constructions, and racial and religious prejudices.**
- ☐ c) Muslims and Arabs cannot be objective while writing about their own culture, but Orientalists writing about Muslims can be considered as objective due to their Westernness.
- ☐ d) Narrative interpretation of the 'Orient' by the Oriental should be encouraged as opposed to the visionary interpretation of the 'Orient' by the Orientalist.

DIRECTIONS for questions 5 to 8: The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

There is no evidence that animals, even apes, possess language, can form concepts or can think abstractly. There is no evidence, in short, that they are symbolic creatures. And without symbols – without language – an animal may be able to react to the world, but it cannot in any significant sense, think about it, nor have beliefs about it. ... For an animal, therefore there can be no distinction between itself and its picture of the world, in other words an animal cannot be self-aware. And without an awareness of self, it cannot separate the world as it is from the world as it seems. For animals, their picture of the world is the world. ...

Because we possess language, we do not simply have experiences, desires and needs, and react to them. ... Humans are aware of themselves as agents, and of the world towards which their agency is directed. Because we can distinguish between ourselves, our thoughts and the world, we can debate, discuss and negotiate among ourselves about the world and our relationship to it, we can talk about morals and norms.

But if language is a necessary condition of being able to think about the world, it is not a sufficient condition. To understand this, we need to return to a problem: the problem with the Cartesian view of the world. Descartes believed that he would doubt everything apart from his own existence for if he did not exist, he could not doubt his existence. For Descartes, therefore, the only certainties were the thoughts in his head. The mind, in the Cartesian world, is the private possession of the individual. No one else has access to my mind just as I can never have access to yours.

But the Cartesian approach raises a central problem: how do I know who 'I' am and what I mean by 'self' or what a 'thought' is? How do I know the meaning of pain, as opposed to its sensation? Feelings are internal, known only to me, but meanings are external. One answer is that we cannot understand anyone else's inner world. We can simply infer that, for instance, another human being is in pain because he is acting as I would if I were in pain.

The philosopher Ludwig Wittgenstein showed that if the only things of which I was certain were the contents of my own mind, then I would not be able to communicate those contents to anyone else. For language is a public activity, words get their sense by being attached to publicly accessible conditions that warrant their application. Language provides the means to bridge the gap between our private worlds, because language is itself a social activity. ... Paradoxically, then our inner feelings are not located entirely inside our heads. They are also the products of our existence as social beings.

According to Descartes, knowledge of one's own mind is the starting point for knowledge of other minds. But Wittgenstein reminded us that without knowledge of other minds it is impossible to have knowledge of our own. Far from inferring other humans' experiences from our own, we can only truly know what goes on inside our own heads by relating to other humans. No animal possesses either language or a social network like ours. Therefore, it is simply not valid to assume that they have inner experiences as we do.

Q5. Since we (humans) have language

- ☐ a) we can form concepts and think about them in abstraction.
- ☐ b) **we can form social relationships with one another.**
- ☐ c) we can form an image of the world.
- ☒ d) **we can react to our experiences, desires and needs through language.** ✖ Your answer is incorrect

Q6. The problem with the Cartesian approach, in the context of language, is that

- ☐ a) there is no 'one to one' match between feelings and the expression of it.
- ☒ **b) one would interpret the feelings of another through his own ability to feel it. X Y**
- ☐ c) it regards the mind as totally private and therefore makes it incapable of communication.
- ☐ d) **there is no correlation between feelings and thoughts.**

Q7. Which of the following would Wittgenstein NOT agree with?

- ☐ a) We know our own thoughts and feelings through knowing the thoughts and feelings of others.
- ☐ b) **Language and social life are essential for us to understand ourselves.**
- ☒ c) **Animals lack language and social living like ours, and hence, cannot have the kind of thoughts that we have.**
- ☐ d) **We can understand the feelings of others by interpreting them in terms of our own.**

Q8. Which of the following is true regarding language, as seen from the passage?

- ☐ a) It is language that enables us to react to our experiences, needs and desires.
- ☐ b) **Animals can be taught to use language to communicate its needs.**
- ☐ c) **Language is not only a means but an end in itself, for thinking about the world.**
- ☒ d) **Language is one of the features that distinguishes man from animals and makes him what he is.**

DIRECTIONS *for questions 9 to 12:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

...Two books, one by Raghuram Rajan and another by Oren Cass, revisit our economic worldview and argue that we should instead put the health of our local communities front and centre. Stable families, good jobs, strong schools, abundant and safe public spaces, and pride in local cultures and history – these are the essential elements of prosperous societies. Neither global markets nor the nation-state can adequately supply them, and sometimes markets and states undermine them...

Rajan calls community the “third pillar” of prosperity, as important as the other two pillars – the state and market. No less than excessive centralized state power, he writes, unmanaged globalization can tear apart the fabric of local communities. Cass is explicit that US trade and immigration policy should focus on American workers first and foremost. This means ensuring that local labour markets are healthy and that there are plenty of good jobs at decent wages. Both authors emphasize the gains from trade and reject protectionism. But they agree we may have gone too far into hyper-globalization and paid insufficient attention to the costs for communities.

When a local factory closes because a firm has decided to outsource to a supplier across the border, more is lost than the hundreds (or thousands) of jobs that move abroad. The impact is multiplied through reduced spending on local goods and services, which means workers and employers across the entire local economy feel the hit. The local government’s tax revenues fall as well, so there is less money to spend on education and other public amenities. Anomie, family breakdown, opioid addiction, and other social ills often follow.

Economists’ usual answer is to call for “greater labour market flexibility”: workers should simply leave depressed areas and seek jobs elsewhere. But as Cass reminds us, geographical mobility must be coupled with “the opportunity to stay.” Even during times of significant migration, the bulk of local populations stayed put and needed good jobs and solid communities...

Ultimately, it is only through the creation and expansion of well-paying jobs that local communities can be made vital. Cass’s proposal is to encourage employment through wage subsidies. Rajan emphasizes the role of local leaders who can mobilize community assets, generate social engagement on the part of local residents, and create a new image – all in the context of more supportive state policies and managed globalization.

Other economists have advocated regionally targeted manufacturing extension programs, fostering partnerships between local employers and universities. Yet others recommend local public spending, such as on job training programs for small and medium-sized enterprises.

We do not have a good fix on what works best, and a fair amount of policy experimentation will be needed to make progress. But the urgency of action is heightened by the fact that ongoing technological trends threaten to exacerbate communities’ existing problems. New digital technologies tend to exhibit scale economies and network effects, which produce concentration rather than localization of production. Instead of diffusing gains, they create winner-take-all markets. The globalization of production networks magnifies such effects further.

How we balance these forces with the needs of communities will shape not only our economic fortunes, but also our social and political environment. As Cass and Rajan show, it is a problem that economists should no longer ignore.

Q9. According to the passage, greater labour market flexibility is effective if

- ☒ a) there is creation of employment through wage subsidies. ✗ You
- ☐ b) local populations choose to migrate.
- ☐ c) good jobs incentivize building of solid local communities.
- ☐ d) workers leave depressed areas to seek jobs elsewhere.

Q10. The example of the closing of a local factory mentioned in the passage primarily demonstrates that

- ☐ a) globalisation affects local communities.
- ☒ b) joblessness is the root cause of all social ills. **✗ Your answer is incorrect**
- ☐ c) local jobs incentivize spending and encourage local economies.
- ☐ d) communities are the backbone of local economies.

Q11. Which of the following best summarises the central argument of the passage?

- ☐ a) **It is unstable local environments which lead to unstable economies.**
- ☐ b) **Governments and markets must try to encourage rather than weaken the growth of local communities.**
- ☒ c) **By focusing on creating jobs, governments can automatically help local communities prosper.** ✖ You
- ☐ d) **Strong local communities help economies better than globalisation does.**

Q12. All the following can be inferred from the first para EXCEPT:

- ☐ a) **Pride in one's culture is an important part of prosperous local communities.**
- ☐ b) **Our current version of economics focuses more on the markets than on the prosperity of individuals.**
- ☐ c) **Markets do not focus on creating prosperous societies.**
- ☐ d) **The functioning of nation states may end up adversely affecting the stability of local communities.**

DIRECTIONS *for questions 13 to 16:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Theoretically, speaking multiple languages may actually confer distinct advantages to the developing brain. Bilinguals do better in qualities like sustained attention and switching between tasks effectively. ...

In 2012, Angela de Bruin, a bilingual, pursued the link between bilingualism and cognition. Normally, to test for an edge in executive function, you give a version of a task where people have to ignore certain stimuli while selectively focussing on others. For instance, in the Simon task, you are shown pictures (often arrows) on either the left or right side of a screen. If you see a right-pointing arrow, you press the right key. It doesn't matter on which side of the screen the arrow appears but only the direction in which it points. Typically, people have faster reaction times on congruent trials – when the right-pointing arrow actually appears on the right, and vice-versa. Bilinguals are supposed to have an advantage in the incongruent trials: when the left arrow appears on the right, and the right arrow appears on the left.

When de Bruin looked at the data, though, in three of the four tasks testing inhibitory control, including the Simon task, the advantage wasn't there. Monolinguals and bilinguals had performed identically. “We thought, maybe the existing literature is not a full, reliable picture of this field,” she said. So, she combed through conference abstracts from 169 conferences that dealt with bilingualism and executive control. About half the presented results provided either complete or partial support for the bilingual advantage on certain tasks, while half provided partial or complete refutation.

De Bruin isn't refuting the notion that there are advantages to being bilingual. But the advantage is neither global nor pervasive. To test where the limits of bilingual advantage lie, and what the real advantage may actually look like, they examined three different groups (English monolinguals, active English-Gaelic bilinguals who spoke Gaelic at home, and passive English-Gaelic bilinguals who no longer used Gaelic regularly). They had each group take part in four tasks – the Simon task, a task of everyday attention, the Tower of London, and a simple task-switching paradigm (you see circles and squares that are either red or blue, and must pay attention to either one color or one shape, depending on the part of the trial).

In the first three tasks, they found no difference between the groups. On the last, they thought they'd finally detected an advantage: on the switch trials – the trials immediately after a change from shape to color or color to shape – the bilinguals, both active and passive, seemed to be quicker. But on digging deeper, they found that it wasn't so much a case of switching faster as it was being slower at the non-switch trials, where shape followed shape and color followed color.

So is there no such thing as a bilingual advantage? No. It's just one study. But it adds further evidence to the argument that the bilingual advantage is sometimes overstated. “I'm definitely not saying there's no bilingual advantage,” de Bruin says. But the advantage may be different from the way many researchers have described it: as a phenomenon that helps children to develop their ability to switch between tasks and, more broadly, enhances their executive-control functions. ...

Q13. What is the main purpose of the author of the passage?

- ☐ a) **To discuss the advantages of bilingualism.**
- ☐ b) **To discuss the extent of the impact of bilingualism on brain functions.**
- ☐ c) **To prove that bilingualism is more advantageous than monolingualism.**
- ☐ d) **To prove that raising a bilingual child is, in large part, a recipe for raising a successful child.**

Q14. Why does De Bruin say, “May be the existing literature is not a full, reliable picture of this field.”?

- ☐ a) The data from her experiment was not reliable enough.
- ☐ b) There should be many more findings related to the advantages of bilingualism presented at conferences than actually become published.
- ☐ c) The result of the experiment conducted was inconclusive.
- ☐ d) The data was insufficient to conclude that bilingualism is advantageous.

Q15. Which of the following would best parallel the perception of the performance of bilinguals and monolinguals in the Simon task (discussed in para 2)?

- ☐ a) **Bilinguals have an advantage in terms of a quicker reaction time when the right-pointing arrow appears on the right and the left-pointing arrow appears on the left than in other circumstances.**
- ☐ b) **Bilinguals have a quicker reaction time when the right-pointing arrow appears on the bottom-right corner of the screen and the left-pointing arrow appears on the top-left corner of the screen than in other circumstances.**
- ☐ c) **Bilinguals have a quicker reaction time when the upward-pointing arrow appears at the bottom and a downward-pointing arrow appears on the top of the screen than in other circumstances.**
- ☐ d) **Bilinguals have a quicker reaction time when the upward-pointing arrow appears at the top and a downward-pointing arrow appears at the bottom of the screen than in other circumstances.**

Q16. Which of the following will support the findings of the study mentioned in paras 4 and 5?

- ☐ a) **A study which shows that part of the brain which deals with colour and shape was as active in bilinguals as in monolinguals.**
- ☐ b) **A study which shows that part of the brain which deals with colour and shape was not as active in bilinguals as compared to monolinguals.**
- ☐ c) **A study which shows that part of the brain which deals with colour and shape was more active in bilinguals as compared to monolinguals.**
- ☐ d) **A study which shows that part of the brain which identifies pattern or visual images was more active in bilinguals than in monolinguals.**

Q17. DIRECTIONS *for question 17:* Five sentences related to a topic are given in the question below. Four of them can be put together to form a meaningful and coherent short paragraph. Identify the odd one out. Choose it as your answer and key it in.

1. Some investigative and enterprising jobs, such as scientific research, are, indeed off limits to the degreeless.
2. However, a recent report in *Psychological Science* suggests that it was not the case that university broadened minds; rather, work seemed to narrow them.
3. That assertion is presumably made in contradistinction to training for work straight after school, which might not be so stimulating.
4. Going to university is supposed to be a mind-broadening experience.
5. Those who have been to university do indeed seem to leave with broader and more inquiring minds than those who have spent their immediate post-school years in vocational training for work.

Q18. DIRECTIONS *for question 18:* A para has been given followed by a question. Read the para carefully and answer the question based on the information given in the para.

Corporate social responsibility or sustainable responsible business is a form of corporate self-regulation integrated into a business model. CSR aims to embrace responsibility for corporate actions and to encourage a positive impact on the environment and stakeholders including consumers, employees, investors, communities, and others. According to a recent study, twenty-five companies in Estonia have been actively engaged in CSR regulation and public policy development in the 21st century and are yet, very profitable. Because of their systems of belief and proactive actions, these twenty-five corporations are philanthropic in nature, punish corrupt directors and employees, follow stringent environmental-protection policies, and have vigorous affirmative-action programs.

Which of the following can be correctly inferred from the statements above?

- ☐ a) **In Estonia, following a belief system of social responsibility helps to make a corporation very profitable and a philanthropist is concerned about the profitability of his company.**
- ☐ b) **It is possible for a corporation in Estonia that follows a system of social responsibility to be very profitable.**
- ☐ c) **Corporations that are very profitable tend to give generously to charity as philanthropy is a way of giving back to society what one takes from it.**
- ☐ d) **Corporations that are philanthropic in Estonia also tend to punish corrupt directors and employees and must be doing so because of their belief in social responsibility.**

Q19. DIRECTIONS *for question 19:* Five sentences related to a topic are given in the question below. Four of them can be put together to form a meaningful and coherent short paragraph. Identify the odd one out. Choose its number as your answer and key it in.

1. Most histories of the martini locate its origins in gold rush California, specifically in the town of Martinez, where a concoction of gin, bitters, maraschino liqueur and a wine glass full of vermouth was known as the 'Martinez special,' which was supposed to taste like champagne.
2. Evidence indicates that the martini actually came not from gentlemen's clubs but from a rough and tumble side of America.
3. A sleek and powerful race car of a drink took its place.
4. Another account holds that Italian immigrant bartender Martini di Arma di Taggia invented the drink at the Knickerbocker Hotel in New York City before World War I.
5. As the recipe spread via word of mouth through California, it lost the 'ez' as well as the distracting sweet liqueur.

Q20. DIRECTIONS *for questions 20 and 21:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. Women play an active role in agricultural extension in Thailand and in the Philippines, but this is predominantly men's territory in Indonesia and Myanmar.
2. One way to overcome this barrier in Indonesia – and allow women more access to the valuable extension services – might be to increase the proportion of female agricultural extension officials.
3. The differences stem from varying in socio-political values, culture, religion or family systems.
4. Thailand and the Philippines are matrilineal societies, while Indonesia has a large Muslim population where religious restrictions discourage women's interaction with extension officials, who are predominantly men.

Q21. DIRECTIONS *for questions 20 and 21:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

- 1. Recognizing Kobe as a worthy adversary attests to Jordan's respect for the man who is often called the Black Mamba.
- 2. Their offensive games are eerily similar in makeup, sometimes right down to the number of dribbles they would take before a particular shot.
- 3. It's also a not-so-subtle way of MJ saying his moves are so effective that not even he himself can defend them, or that he relishes at looking in a mirror.
- 4. When watching Kobe Bryant, you often see a spitting image of Michael Jordan.

Q22. DIRECTIONS *for questions 22:* A para has been given followed by a question. Read the para carefully and answer the question based on the information given in the para.

The Cambrian period, part of the Paleozoic era, produced the most intense burst of evolution ever known. The Cambrian Explosion saw an incredible diversity of life emerge, including many major animal groups alive today. Among them were the chordates, to which vertebrates (animals with backbones) such as humans belong. What sparked this biological bonanza isn't clear. It may be that oxygen in the atmosphere, thanks to emissions from photosynthesizing cyanobacteria and algae, were at levels needed to fuel the growth of more complex body structures and ways of living. It may be that the environment became more hospitable, with a warming climate and rising sea levels flooding low-lying landmasses to create shallow, marine habitats ideal for spawning new life-forms.

Which of the following would be most important to determine to evaluate the hypothesis that a change in something sparked the burst of evolution witnessed in the Cambrian period?

- ☐ a) **Whether the rate at which new species appeared on the planet was drastically higher than the earlier rate.**
- ☐ b) **Whether the new species which appeared on the planet were different from the ones already present.**
- ☐ c) **Whether there was a drastic change in the atmospheric conditions during that period.**
- ☐ d) **Whether life-forms thrive better in marine habitats.**

Q23. DIRECTIONS *for questions 23:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. It takes nearly six months, on average, for a manuscript to wend its way from submission to publication and before a paper is accepted by a journal, it is often rejected by one or more others.
2. The reason need not be a fatal flaw in the research; sometimes the work is simply not splashy enough for outlets high up in the pecking order.
3. But in the process, each journal's editors send the paper for peer review – appraisal by experts in the relevant field – in much the same way that each prospective purchaser of a house commissions his own survey.
4. Ask a researcher what annoys him most about scientific publishing, and slowness will come near the top of the list of gripes.

Q24. DIRECTIONS *for question 24:* A para has been given followed by a question. Read the para carefully and answer the question based on the information given in the para.

Researchers report that because of increases in size, early human ancestors would have had much higher energetic, or caloric, requirements—perhaps as much as 35% higher— than earlier hominins. Larger brain and body size conferred advantages—they enhanced the ability to exploit and modify a wider range of habitats, creating new niches, increased the effectiveness of prey collection, allowed females and other group members to carry infants to an older age, and resulted in more effective thermoregulation and water utilization—and thus can be seen as adaptations. This also carried costs, namely, the higher energy requirements to “run” the larger body and brain. They simply had to consume more calories than earlier hominins. The increase in energy requirements suggests that a change in dietary patterns accompanied the appearance of Homo erectus. Researchers hypothesize that this dietary change took the form of greater reliance on animal protein and other high-energy food resources.

Which of the following would be most useful to know in order to evaluate the argument?

- ☐ a) **Whether there is evidence of an increase in hunting and/or scavenging activities during the said time period?**
- ☐ b) **Whether there is evidence of a fossil record for increased reliance on stone tools?**
- ☐ c) **Whether animal protein was a high-energy food resource?**
- ☐ d) **Whether there is evidence for greater metabolic rates in the form of gut size amongst early humans?**